



Text Forecasts

User Guide

This [user guide](#) provides a summary of the standard text forecast products available to Registered Users via FTP and cloud (S)FTP.

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Data Product Overview

The following products are routinely produced for each state and territory:

- State or Territory Forecast
- Précis Forecast
- City Forecast
- Town Forecast
- District Forecast (N/A for Northern Territory)
- Coastal Waters and Local Waters Forecasts

Some other products are specific to their respective state or territory, and may be produced seasonally, such as some fire weather products.

Product Subscription Options

Table 1 lists the available text forecast product subscription options. Please see our [Product Catalogue](#) for current prices.

Bundle Code	Bundle Description	Product Codes included
IDBZ0009	Text Forecasts - Australia - Bundle	All product codes listed in Table 3
IDBX0009	Text Forecasts - State - Bundle	All products with codes starting with IDX listed in Table 3. E.g. the IDBD0009 bundle includes all products in Table 3 with codes starting with IDD.

Table 1 List of available text forecast product subscription options (where X represents the state/territory of origin – **D** for Northern Territory (NT), **N** for New South Wales (NSW) and the Australian Capital Territory (ACT), **Q** for Queensland (Qld), **S** for South Australia (SA), **T** for Tasmania (Tas), **V** for Victoria (Vic) and **W** for Western Australia (WA))

File Location

Files are available in the /fwo subdirectory of Registered Users' directories.

These products are available via cloud FTP (ftp-reg.cloud.bom.gov.au), SFTP (sftp-reg.cloud.bom.gov.au) and ftp.bom.gov.au.

Files are also available via anonymous FTP at: <ftp://ftp.bom.gov.au/anon/gen/fwo/>. Please note that use of data from anonymous FTP should be in accordance with the [copyright notice](#) and [disclaimer](#).

File Naming Convention

Files are overwritten with each issue and file names are unchanging allowing for direct addressing. Product files conform to the following naming convention:

IDXnnnnn.ext

File-name key	
IDXnnnnn	Product Code as listed in Table 3
X	represents the state/territory of origin – D for Northern Territory, N for NSW and ACT, Q for Queensland, S for South Australia, T for Tasmania, V for Victoria and W for Western Australia
ext	file-type extension (xml, amoc.xml, pdf, txt, html or wrap.html)

Product Descriptions

State and Territory Forecasts

These products provide a broad forecast of weather conditions, rainfall, temperature and winds across each state and the Northern Territory.

Early morning forecasts cover the current day and the next three days. Afternoon forecasts cover the remainder of the current day and the next four days.

Précis Forecasts

These products provide a forecast of the [chance of any rain](#), [possible rainfall amounts](#), maximum and minimum temperatures, a forecast [icon code](#) and a précis forecast (short summary of less than 30 characters) for the précis locations listed in the Point Places IDM00013.dbf file referenced in the [spatial data user guide](#). Links to maps and lists of forecast locations for each state/territory are also provided in Table 2.

Morning forecasts cover the current day and the next six days. Afternoon and evening forecasts cover the remainder of the current day and the next seven days.

State/ Territory	List of Précis Forecast Locations	Map Showing Précis Forecast Locations
Northern Territory	NT Précis Forecast Locations - list	NT Précis Forecast Locations - map
New South Wales and Australian Capital Territory	NSW and ACT Précis Forecast Locations - list	NSW and ACT Précis Forecast Locations - map
Queensland	QLD Précis Forecast Locations - list	QLD Précis Forecast Locations - map
South Australia	SA Précis Forecast Locations - list	SA Précis Forecast Locations - map

State/ Territory	List of Précis Forecast Locations	Map Showing Précis Forecast Locations
Tasmania	TAS Précis Forecast Location - list	TAS Précis Forecast Location - map
Victoria	VIC Précis Forecast Location - list	VIC Précis Forecast Location - map
Western Australia	WA Précis Forecast Location - list	WA Précis Forecast Location - map

Table 2 Précis forecast locations

District and Local Area Forecasts

District Forecasts provide a general forecast of weather conditions, rainfall, temperature, winds, [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#) for Public Weather Forecast Districts in [Queensland](#), [New South Wales](#) and the [Australian Capital Territory](#), [Victoria](#), [Tasmania](#), [South Australia](#) and [Western Australia](#). Morning forecasts cover the current day and the next three days (except for [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#)). Afternoon and evening forecasts cover the remainder of the current day and the next four days.

The Alpine District Forecast - Snowy Mountains (NSW) provides a forecast of weather conditions, wind, [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#) and probability of snow at elevations of 1000, 1400 and 1800 metres for the Snowy Mountains Public Weather Forecast District. Maximum and minimum temperature and précis forecasts are included for key locations. The XML file also includes [icon codes](#). Morning forecasts cover the current day and the next three days (except for [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#)). Afternoon and evening forecasts cover the remainder of the current day and the next four days.

The Overland Track Forecast (Tas) provides a forecast of weather conditions, wind, [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#) for the Overland Track Forecast Area. Maximum and minimum temperature, [chance of any rain](#), [possible rainfall amounts](#), and précis forecasts are included for key locations. The XML file also includes [icon codes](#). Morning forecasts cover the current day and the next six days (except for [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#)). Afternoon and evening forecasts cover the remainder of the current day and the next seven days.

City Forecasts

The city forecast products for each state and the Northern Territory provide a forecast of weather conditions, winds, [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#) for major metropolitan centres and significant tourist locations (such as Cradle Valley in Tasmania and Kakadu National Park in the Northern Territory). Note that the "forecast" text in these products refers to the broader "metropolitan" area.

The City Forecast - Alpine Centres (NSW) provides a forecast of weather conditions, winds, [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#) for the New South Wales Alpine Area. Maximum and minimum temperature, [chance of any rain](#), [possible rainfall amounts](#), and précis forecasts are included for key locations. The XML file also includes [icon codes](#).

Morning forecasts cover the current day and the next six days (except for [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#)). Afternoon and evening forecasts cover the remainder of the current day and the next seven days.

Town Forecasts

These products provide a forecast of weather conditions, winds, [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#) for major centres in each state and the Northern Territory.

The Town Forecast - Alice Springs (NT) provides a forecast of weather conditions, winds, [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#) for the town of Alice Springs. Maximum and minimum temperature, [chance of any rain](#), [possible rainfall amounts](#), and précis forecasts are included for key locations. The XML file also includes [icon codes](#).

Morning forecasts are for the current day and the next six days (except for [UV](#) and [Fire Danger Rating](#)). Afternoon and evening forecasts are for the remainder of the current day and the next seven days.

Island Forecasts

Norfolk and Lord Howe Island products provide a forecast of weather conditions, winds, seas, swell, [UV](#), maximum and minimum temperature and précis forecasts. The early morning forecast covers the current day and the next three days (except for [UV](#)). The afternoon forecast covers the remainder of the current day and the next four days.

The Cocos (Keeling) and Christmas Island products include the synoptic situation and provide a forecast of weather conditions, winds and maximum temperature. The early morning forecast covers the current day and the next two days, with a forecast of seas and swell included for the current day. The afternoon forecast covers the remainder of the current day and the next three days, with a forecast of seas and swell included for the remainder of the current day and the next day. The afternoon forecast also includes a forecast of minimum temperature for the next day.

Coastal and Local Waters Forecasts

Coastal Waters Forecasts provide a forecast of winds, seas, swells and other weather conditions for [areas within 60 nautical miles of the coast](#), as well as a summary of the current weather patterns affecting the state's coastal areas. A warning summary is included for each coastal waters zone for days one and two if a [marine wind warning](#) is current, indicating the highest category of wind warning.

Morning forecasts are for the current day and the next two days. Afternoon and evening forecasts are for the remainder of the current day and the next three days.

Local waters forecasts provide a forecast of winds, seas and other weather conditions over each [local waters area](#) (such as bays, harbours and inland waters on which frequent boating activity occurs).

More information on local and coastal waters forecasts is available in the [Marine Knowledge Centre](#).

Fire Danger Ratings

Fire Danger Ratings provide awareness of the extent to which weather conditions will enhance fire related risks.

Fire Danger Ratings 4 Days products are issued twice daily during the local fire weather season in NSW/ACT, NT, Vic and WA and in the afternoon in Qld, SA and Tas.

The early morning and mid-morning issues of the District, City and Town forecasts available via FTP include Fire Danger Ratings for the day of issue, while the afternoon and evening issues of these forecasts include the Fire Danger Ratings for the following day.

The local fire weather season is year-round in NSW/ACT, NT, Qld and WA. For other states please see the [Fire Weather Service Level Specification](#).

More information on Fire Danger Ratings is available in the [Fire Weather Knowledge Centre](#).

Fire Weather Forecasts

Fire Weather Forecasts - Day 0/1 are available for the NT, Vic and WA in the IDBZ0009 bundle and via anonymous FTP. These products are issued twice daily during the local fire weather season. The local fire weather season is year-round in the NT and WA. For information on the local fire weather season in Victoria please see the [Fire Weather Service Level Specification](#).

Additional Information

UV Index values

The early morning and mid-morning issues of the District, City and Town forecasts available via FTP include UV Index values and Sun protection times for the day of issue, while the afternoon and evening issues of these forecasts include the UV Index values and Sun protection times for the following day.

For UV index values for subsequent days, please see the products included in the [Text-based UV Index Forecast bundle](#) (IDBZ0024) available via registered user FTP and cloud (S)FTP. [Gridded UV Index forecasts](#) are also available via registered user FTP and cloud (S)FTP.

Chance of any rain' and 'Possible rainfall' amounts

Please note that these are two separate pieces of information. 'Chance of any rain' or probability of precipitation refers to the likelihood of the selected location receiving more than the minimum measurable amount of rainfall (0.2 mm) over the 24 hours from midnight to midnight.

Whenever measurable rainfall is forecast, 'possible rainfall' is represented as a range between two values (precipitation range). The first value means the location has a 75% (high) chance of receiving at least that amount of rain. The second represents a 25% (low) chance of receiving at least that amount. The 'possible rainfall' amount will not be included if the chance of rain is less than 25% for the day. Please see the following article for some examples: [Right as rain: How to interpret the daily rainfall forecast - Social Media Blog - Bureau of Meteorology](#).

Icon Codes

The icon code provides a convenient mechanism to match a weather graphic against the forecast for each day. Please see Table 27 of the [Australian Digital Forecast Database ADFD](#) user guide for weather graphics.

Spatial Information

XML versions refer to AAC codes described in the [Bureau of Meteorology spatial data user guide](#). TXT, HTML and PDF versions contain defined names which can also be mapped to shapefiles.



Products and Issue Times

Table 3 provides a list of products included in the bundles listed in Table 1 and their routine issue times. All times are in local time.

		Issue times			
Product Code	Description	Early morning	Mid-morning	Afternoon	Evening
State or Territory Forecasts					
IDD10111	Territory Forecast (NT)	2:30am	–	3:00pm	–
IDN10031	State Forecast (NSW)	4:20am	–	4:40pm	–
IDQ10700	State Forecast (QLD)	3:00am	–	3:30pm	–
IDS10033	State Forecast (SA)	4:00am	–	4:00pm	–
IDT13100	State Forecast (TAS)	4:00am	–	4:30pm	–
IDV10310	State Forecast (VIC)	4:00am	–	4:30pm	–
IDW10100	State Forecast (WA)	1:45am	–	1:30pm	–
District and Local Area Forecasts					
IDN11020	District Forecast XML Package (NSW)	5:05am	10:00am	4:40pm	10:00pm
IDN11032	Alpine District Forecast - Snowy Mountains (NSW)	5:05am	10:00am	4:40pm	10:00pm

Product Code	Description	Issue times			
		Early morning	Mid-morning	Afternoon	Evening
IDN11039	District Forecast - Australian Capital Territory (NSW)	5:05am	10:00am	4:40pm	10:00pm
IDQ10606	District Forecast XML Package (QLD)	3:30am	9:00am	3:15pm	9:00pm
IDS11055	District Forecast XML Package (SA)	4:10am	9:30am	3:55pm	9:30pm
IDT13620	Overland Track Forecast (TAS)	4:15am	10:00am	4:20pm	10:00pm
IDT16000	District Forecast - All Districts (TAS)	4:40am	10:00am	4:25pm	10:00pm
IDV10750	District Forecast XML Package (VIC)	4:40am	10:00am	4:40pm	10:00pm
IDW13010	District Forecast XML Package (WA)	1:30am	7:00am	1:25pm	7:00pm
City Forecasts					
IDD10198	City Forecast XML Package (NT)	2:50am	8:30am	2:50pm	8:30pm
IDN11050	City Forecast XML Package (NSW)	4:35am	10:00am	4:35pm	10:00pm
IDN11055	City Forecast - Alpine Centres (NSW)	4:35am	10:00am	4:35pm	10:00pm
IDQ10605	City Forecast XML Package (QLD)	3:20am	9:00am	3:20pm	9:00pm
IDS10037	City Forecast XML Package (SA)	3:50am	9:30am	3:40pm	9:30pm
IDT13630	City Forecast XML Package (TAS)	4:15am	10:00am	4:20pm	10:00pm
IDV10751	City Forecast XML Package (VIC)	4:05am	10:00am	4:20pm	10:00pm
IDW12400	City Forecast XML Package (WA)	1:10am	7:00am	1:20pm	7:00pm

		Issue times			
Product Code	Description	Early morning	Mid-morning	Afternoon	Evening
Town Forecasts					
IDD10161	Town Forecast - Alice Springs (NT)	2:50am	8:30am	2:50pm	8:30pm
IDD10208	Town Forecast XML Package (NT)	3:00am	8:30am	3:00pm	8:30pm
IDN11100	Town Forecast XML Package (NSW)	4:50am	10:00am	4:20pm	10:00pm
IDQ11296	Town Forecast XML Package (QLD)	3:25am	9:00am	3:30pm	9:00pm
IDS11039	Town Forecast XML Package (SA)	4:00am	9:30am	3:45pm	9:30pm
IDT13515	Town Forecast XML Package (TAS)	4:30am	10:00am	4:15pm	10:00pm
IDV10752	Town Forecast XML Package (VIC)	4:30am	10:00am	4:30pm	10:00pm
IDW14100	Town Forecast XML Package (WA)	1:20am	7:00am	1:30pm	7:00pm
Précis Forecasts					
IDD10207	Précis Forecast XML Package (NT)	2:40am	8:30am	2:40pm	8:30pm
IDN11060	Précis Forecast XML Package (NSW)	4:15am	10:00am	4:00pm	10:00pm
IDQ11295	Précis Forecast XML Package (QLD)	3:10am	9:00am	3:10pm	9:00pm
IDS10044	Précis Forecast XML Package (SA)	3:45am	9:30am	3:30pm	9:30pm
IDT16710	Précis Forecast XML Package (TAS)	4:10am	10:00am	4:10pm	10:00pm
IDV10580	Précis Forecast (VIC)	4:00am	10:00am	4:05pm	10:00pm
IDV10753	Précis Forecast XML Package (VIC)	4:00am	10:00am	4:05pm	10:00pm

Product Code	Description	Issue times			
		Early morning	Mid-morning	Afternoon	Evening
IDW14199	Précis Forecast XML Package (WA)	1:00am	7:00am	1:00pm	7:00pm
Island Forecasts					
IDN10008	Norfolk Island Forecast (NSW)	6:00am	–	4:00pm	–
IDN10033	Lord Howe Island Forecast (NSW)	5:30am	–	3:30pm	–
IDW10600	Cocos Islands Forecast (WA)	5:30am	–	4:30pm	–
IDW10700	Christmas Island Forecast (WA)	5:30am	–	4:30pm	–
Coastal and Local Waters Forecasts					
IDD11030	Coastal Waters Forecast - All Districts (NT)	2:30am	8:30am	2:30pm	8:30pm
IDN11001	Coastal Waters Forecast - All Districts (NSW)	4:00am	10:00am	4:05pm	10:00pm
IDQ11290	Coastal Waters Forecast - All Districts (QLD)	3:00am	9:00am	3:00pm	9:00pm
IDS11072	Coastal Waters Forecast - All Districts (SA)	3:40am	9:30am	3:30pm	9:30pm
IDT12329	Coastal Waters Forecast - All Districts (TAS)	4:00am	10:00am	4:05pm	10:00pm
IDV10200	Coastal Waters Forecast - All Districts (VIC)	4:10am	10:00am	4:15pm	10:00pm
IDW11160	Coastal Waters Forecast - All Districts (WA)	1:00am	7:00am	1:00pm	7:00pm
IDN11013	Local Waters Forecast - Sydney Enclosed Waters (NSW)	3:55am	10:00am	4:05pm	10:00pm
IDS10036	Local Waters Forecast XML Package (SA)	3:40am	9:30am	3:30pm	9:30pm
IDT12460	Local Waters Forecast XML Package (TAS)	4:00am	10:00am	4:05pm	10:00pm

Product Code	Description	Issue times			
		Early morning	Mid-morning	Afternoon	Evening
IDV10465	Local Waters Forecast XML Package (VIC)	4:10am	10:00am	4:15pm	10:00pm
IDW11500	Local Waters Forecast XML Package (WA)	1:00am	7:00am	1:00pm	7:00pm
Fire Danger Ratings					
IDD10731	Fire Danger Ratings 4 Days (NT)	5:00am	–	4:00pm	–
IDN10016	Fire Danger Ratings 4 Days (NSW)	5:05am	–	4:15pm	–
IDQ13016	Fire Danger Ratings 4 Days (QLD)	–	–	4:00pm	–
IDS10070	Fire Danger Ratings 4 Days (SA)	–	–	4:05pm	–
IDT13151	Fire Danger Ratings 4 Days (TAS)	–	–	4:00pm	–
IDV18555	Fire Danger Ratings 4 Days (VIC)	5:30am	–	4:00pm	–
IDW15100	Fire Danger Ratings 4 Days (WA)	4:35am	–	4:10pm	–
Fire Weather Forecasts					
IDD10721	Fire Weather Forecast - Day 0/1 (NT)	5:30am	–	4:00pm	–
IDV18560	Fire Weather Forecast - Day 0/1 (VIC)	6:30am	–	4:00pm	–
IDW15000	Fire Weather Forecast - Day 0/1 (WA)	4:30am	–	4:00pm	–

Table 3 Issue times by product code (in local time)



Contact us

For enquiries about real-time data please email webreg@bom.gov.au